

SOA IDEATHON 2026

Detailed Guidelines

Internal Hackathon for Selection of Teams for Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026

Faculty of Engineering & Technology (ITER), Siksha 'O' Anusandhan Deemed to be University, Bhubaneswar.

1. About SOA IDEATHON 2026

SOA IDEATHON 2026 is the internal hackathon organized by the Faculty of Engineering & Technology (ITER), Siksha 'O' Anusandhan Deemed to be University, to identify and shortlist student teams for participation and nomination in Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026.

It gives students a platform to identify real-world problems, build innovative technology-driven solutions, develop functional prototypes, and demonstrate their technical capabilities.

2. Key Dates at a Glance

Activity	Date / Time	Remarks
Edit option closes	22nd August 2026	Last date to edit registration details, problem statement and PPT
Final registration closes	25th August 2026, 11:59 PM	Registration form closes
Round 2: Online Hackathon	1st–2nd September 2026	24-hour online development and evaluation (1st Sept 5:00 PM to 2nd Sept 5:00 PM) Selection of Top 50 for Offline SOA Ideathon 2026 round
Round 3: Offline Hackathon	5th September 2026 (9:00 AM onwards)	Top 50 teams will participate; Top 10 will be Awarded (Total Prize pool worth 95,000/-)

3. Team Eligibility & Registration

- Each team must consist of exactly six (6) student members.
- At least one member of every team must be a female student.
- Each student may register with only one team - participation in more than one team is strictly prohibited.
- Multidisciplinary teams are strongly encouraged.
- Every team must nominate one Team Leader / primary contact.
- All six members are expected to actively participate in every evaluation round.
- Information provided must be accurate and complete; incorrect, duplicate or misleading entries may lead to disqualification.

Editing Your Registration

- An **edit facility** will be **open up to 22nd August 2026 at 11:59 PM**, which lets teams update details, including the selected problem statement and PPT.
- The **final registration** form will **close on 25th August 2026 at 11:59 PM**.
- Team leaders should verify all respective team information, PPTs, and YouTube links before final submission.

4. Problem Statement Selection

As of yet, official SIH 2026 problem statements have not yet been released on the SIH portal. SOA Ideathon 2026 will therefore provide an Excel sheet/pdf of currently prepared problem statements for teams to choose from.

- Select your preferred problem statement from the Excel sheet/pdf provided by the Organizing Team.
- Enter the Problem Statement ID/number, title, and other required information correctly in the registration form.
- Teams may begin preparing their solution based on the selected problem statement right away.
- **If SIH 2026 releases new official problem statements before 22nd August 2026**, teams may switch to a newly released statement, but must update their registration and upload a revised PPT before the 22nd August deadline.

Students should regularly monitor the official SIH portal and SOA IDEATHON communication channels for updates.

5. Round 1 : PPT & Prototype Video Screening

All registered teams must submit a PPT (**strictly abiding by the prescribed format** which is provided in the SIH portal <https://www.sih.gov.in/letters/2026/SIH2026-IDEA-Presentation-Format.pptx>) describing their proposed solution, along with a **YouTube link to a prototype (preferably working) demonstration video** of a **maximum of 3 minutes**.

Recommended PPT Content

- Problem statement and understanding of the problem.
- Existing challenges / limitations.
- Proposed solution, innovation and key features.
- System architecture / workflow and technology stack.
- Implementation methodology and current prototype status.
- Expected impact, beneficiaries, scalability and sustainability.
- Future scope / implementation roadmap.

Prototype Demonstration Video

- Maximum duration: 3 minutes.
- Must show the proposed solution, key features, working methodology and current prototype status a working prototype or proof-of-concept is strongly encouraged.
- Can involve software, AI/ML, simulation, UI/UX, hardware, IoT or another suitable proof-of-concept.
- The YouTube link must be accessible to the evaluation committee (Unlisted videos are acceptable). Test the link before final submission.

Round 1 Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	What Will Be Considered
Innovation & Uniqueness	Originality, novelty and creativity
Problem Relevance	Alignment with the selected problem statement
Technical Feasibility	Practicality and suitability of the technology
Prototype Readiness	Current development status and demonstrability
Impact	Potential social, economic or industrial impact
Scalability & Sustainability	Potential for expansion and long-term use
Implementation Plan	Clarity and practicality of the development roadmap

Teams shortlisted in Round 1 qualify for the 24-Hour Online Hackathon.

6. Round 2 : 24-Hour Online Hackathon

Item	Details
Date	1-2 September 2026
Start	1st September 2026, 5:00 PM
End	2nd September 2026, 5:00 PM
Duration	24 hours
Mode	Online (Discord Platform)
Participants	Teams shortlisted from Round 1

This is the important round, where shortlisted teams use the 24-hour window to develop, improve, integrate, test and demonstrate their solution.

Mandatory Activities

- Development and enhancement of the prototype keeping the comments of the judges in mind; integration of software, hardware, AI/ML or other modules.
- Testing, validation and improvement of functionality and user experience.
- Preparation of the final demonstration, presentation and required documentation.
- At least 4 members must be present at all times. During evaluations of the judges, all 6 members have to be present in proper formal attire.

Evaluation Focus

- Innovation, originality and understanding of the problem.
- Technical implementation, feasibility and prototype readiness.
- Quality of demonstration, potential impact, scalability and sustainability.
- Overall implementation and future development plan.

Expectations & Conduct

- All six team members are expected to actively participate, working only on the team's registered problem statement.
- The final prototype should be demonstrable to the evaluation committee, with appropriate project documentation maintained.
- External APIs, datasets, open-source models, libraries and third-party resources must be properly acknowledged.
- Teams must comply with intellectual property, copyright and privacy requirements.
- Plagiarism, impersonation, misrepresentation or any unfair practice may lead to disqualification.

The top 50 teams from this round qualify for the Offline Hackathon.

7. Round 3 : Offline Hackathon & Final Evaluation

Item	Details
Date	5th September 2026
Time	9:00 AM onwards
Mode	Offline
Duration	9 hours
Participants	Top 50 teams from the Online Hackathon

Note:

- The Top 50 teams will present their working prototypes before the evaluation committee.
- Detailed instructions on venue, reporting time, presentation format, evaluation process and facilities will be shared separately.
- These Top 50 teams will be shortlisted for SIH 2026 Finale.

8. Submission Checklist

Stage	Required / Expected Submission
Registration	Team details (6 members incl. one female member) and selected problem statement
Round 1	PPT + YouTube prototype demo video (max. 3 minutes)
Problem statement change (if any within 22nd August 2026)	Updated registration details + revised PPT

9. Important Links

- SOA IDEATHON 2026 Registration Form: <https://forms.gle/EQzi7QUAB8cAf8KQA>
- Problem Statement PDF: [SOA IDEATHON 2026 Problem Statements.pdf](#)
- PPT Template / Guidelines: <https://www.sih.gov.in/letters/2026/SIH2026-IDEA-Presentation-Format.pptx>
- Official SIH Portal: <https://www.sih.gov.in>
- Official SOA IDEATHON Communication Channel: <https://chat.whatsapp.com/GEkz7Y4MeuC9CInRAODHg8>

10. Frequently Asked Questions

- **Q: SIH 2026 problem statements aren't out yet - what should we do?**
A: Choose one from the Excel sheet/pdf provided by SOA IDEATHON and proceed with registration and preparation.
- **Q: Can we switch problem statements once SIH releases new ones?**
A: Yes, if released before 22nd August 2026 - update your registration and upload a revised PPT via the edit facility.
- **Q: Until when can we edit our registration?**
A: Until 22nd August 2026, 11:59 PM.
- **Q: When does the registration form close?**
A: 25th August 2026, 11:59 PM.
- **Q: Can a student be part of more than one team?**
A: No - each student may register with only one team.
- **Q: How many members must a team have?**
A: Exactly six, including at least one female member.
- **Q: What is the maximum length of the Round 1 video?**
A: 3 minutes.
- **Q: How many teams reach the Offline Hackathon?**
A: The Top 50 teams from the Online Hackathon.

11. General Instructions

- Read this document carefully before registering.
- Regularly monitor official SOA IDEATHON channels for announcements and updates.
- Do not wait until the last moment to complete registration or upload the PPT.
- Team leaders are responsible for ensuring all submitted information and links are correct and accessible.
- The Organizing Team may issue additional instructions or operational changes as needed for smooth conduction of the event.
- Decisions of the Organizing Team on the conduct and evaluation of SOA IDEATHON 2026 are final, subject to applicable institutional and SIH guidelines.

12. Contact

For queries related to SOA IDEATHON 2026:

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SOA IDEATHON 2026 Organizing Team